



# County Commissioners Meeting August 17th 2020

| Meeting Metadata | Details                                                                                               |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Video Recording  | <a href="https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_s0tKAydKe4">https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_s0tKAydKe4</a> |
| Publication Date | 2020-08-17T14:53:03Z                                                                                  |
| Target Category  | delaware_county                                                                                       |

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## Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Summary

**Meeting Date:** Monday, August 17, 2020

**Meeting Time:** 9:01 AM

### 1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the Delaware County Commissioners meeting to order at 9:01 AM, commencing with the Pledge of Allegiance. An opening announcement was made noting that Sherry was attending remotely via laptop due to quarantining after coming into contact with someone with COVID-19.
- **Attendance:**
  - **Present:** Ms. Reagan, Mr. King, Mr. Henry, Mr. Brook (full board present; note: Sherry participating remotely via video/laptop).
  - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly designated by title in the opening remarks, but leading the proceedings.

### 2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Minutes:**

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Minutes from the August 3, 2020 meeting were approved by roll call vote (Ms. Reagan abstained; Mr. King yes; Mr. Henry yes).
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### 3. Substantive Business & Board Action

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#### Appointments

- **[00:1:32] Reappointment of Larry Clendenin to the Fair Board**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board of Commissioners.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Commissioners noted Larry Clendenin's long tenure and strong performance on the fair board.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed unanimously by roll call vote (Mr. King yes, Ms. Reagan yes, Mr. Henry yes).

#### Presentations

- **00:02:22 Census 2020 Presentation**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Julie Mason, Census Committee.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Mason emphasized the urgent need for trusted community messengers as the self-response deadline approaches earlier than expected (September 30 instead of October 30 due to pandemic adjustments). She detailed the financial impact: losing 100 uncounted individuals costs approximately \$2,700 per person over 10 years, totaling a \$2.7 million loss for the county that funds local streets, schools, and lunch programs. Current self-response statistics were shared (e.g., Muncie at 51.4%, Daleville at 78.5%, Eden at 58%, Selma at 64.8%, and Indiana overall at 57.5%). Mentioned mobile questionnaire assistance operating Tuesday through Saturday from 12:00 PM to 6:00 PM to assist low-response areas.

#### Contracts & Agreements

- **00:08:39 Safe and Sanitized Seasonal Solutions Contract**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board of Commissioners.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Contract for bi-weekly sanitization of various county offices, including plans to expand to the 911 center, highway department, and EMS. Charlie reported that the vendor is doing an outstanding job with specialized equipment.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Mr. King yes, Ms. Reagan yes, Mr. Henry yes).
- **00:09:56 Peterson Consulting Services Inc. Agreement**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Craycraft / Board of Commissioners.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Renewal for capital asset reporting services for 2020 to maintain current asset tracking, which previously increased annual returns by

approximately \$40,000.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Ms. Reagan yes, Mr. King yes, Mr. Henry yes).
- **00:10:49 Baker Tilly Financial Consultants Agreement**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** John (Financial Consultant).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Agreement for Baker Tilly to review county financial issues, primarily regarding EDIT (Economic Development Income Tax) revenue and reporting requirements for the jail project financing. Consultants noted that the Department of Local Government Finance (DLGF) forecasts lower EDIT income for 2021 and potentially 2022. However, the county remains in a strong fiscal position with a positive unappropriated EDIT balance of over \$2.5 million at the end of 2019, contrasting with the city's previous deficit. Commissioners reaffirmed their opposition to raising local income taxes for the new justice center, noting the county is well on pace.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Mr. King yes, Ms. Reagan yes, Mr. Henry yes).

#### **Ordinances (First Readings & Emergency Adoptions)**

- **00:16:04 Ordinance No. 2020-012: Creating a New Fund for Coronavirus Relief Grant**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jamie Baine, Administrator of the Delaware County Health Department.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Establishes a fund to receive grant money from the Indiana State Department of Health to fund COVID-19 testing. The county partnered with Open Door Health Services to run a free public testing clinic operating at least 5 days a week, including evenings and Saturdays. The state supplies testing kits and lab analysis. Because grant allocation windows are tight, the administration requested an emergency suspension of rules to adopt the ordinance immediately.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced, rules suspended, and adopted by unanimous roll call vote (Mr. King yes, Ms. Reagan yes, Mr. Henry yes).
- **00:19:32 Ordinance No. 2020-013: Establishing Delaware County Sheriff's JAG Grant Fund**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Captain Tony Johnson, Delaware County Sheriff's Office.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Maintains the Department of Justice Byrne Justice Assistance Grant (JAG) to assist the department with overtime needs for extra patrols and special events. Requested an emergency suspension of rules to process grant allocations.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced, rules suspended, and adopted by unanimous roll call vote (Ms. Reagan yes, Mr. King yes, Mr. Henry yes).
- **00:21:31 Ordinance No. 2020-014: Amending the Composition of the Delaware County Convention and Tourism Commission**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** John (Legal/Financial Counsel) / Victor Whitehead.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Updates the commission's board composition ordinance (originally adopted in 1983) to comply with updated state statutes. State law dictates that mayoral appointments must reflect the city's population percentage within the county (yielding 5 appointments for the mayor on a 9-member board), with the remaining 4 appointments allocated to the commissioners. Existing members will serve out their current terms before new appointment proportions take effect.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced for first reading by roll call vote (Mr. King yes, Ms. Reagan yes, Mr. Henry yes).

### Other Board Actions & Appeals

- **00:26:48 Legal Appeal Authorization (Meeks Cockerel / Dollar General Project)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board of Commissioners / John.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Based on a recommendation and email from legal counsel Meeks Cockerel regarding the Dollar General project proposed along Highway 67, the board considered filing a formal legal appeal.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote to authorize Meeks Cockerel to file the appeal on behalf of the county (Ms. Reagan yes, Mr. King yes, Mr. Henry yes).
- **00:27:51 Payment of Claims**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board of Commissioners.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Review and approval of municipal claims totaling \$1,480,303.79.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Ms. Reagan yes, Mr. King yes, Mr. Henry yes).

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## 4. Department Head & Elected Official Updates

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- **00:27:32 Court Administration (Emily Anderson):** Reported on research into bringing food trucks to the new courthouse facility. Anderson coordinated with the board of health regarding permits and plans to distribute an employee survey to gauge interest and manage a seasonal schedule calendar.
  - **00:25:22 9-1-1 Communications (Paul Singleton):** Provided a public update on the new telephone project. Hardware installation is underway in the back room and will expand to the dispatch floor next week, followed by nine training sessions. The system is expected to go live between September 9 and mid/late September 2020. The two-year project is 60% reimbursed by a federal grant.
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## 5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

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- *No members of the public signed up or spoke during the general public comment period.*  
00:28:14
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## 6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

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- **Announcements:** None specified beyond ongoing administrative business.
  - **Adjournment / Recess:**
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to recess approved by unanimous roll call vote (Mr. King yes, Ms. Reagan yes, Mr. Henry yes). Meeting recessed at an unspecified concluding time 00:28:30.
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